

Docker Complete Course - Levels 5 to 15

Deep Dive into Image Management, Container Operations, and Docker Compose

LEVEL 5: Docker Image Deep Learning

Topic 1: Deep Understanding of Images

Image Architecture:

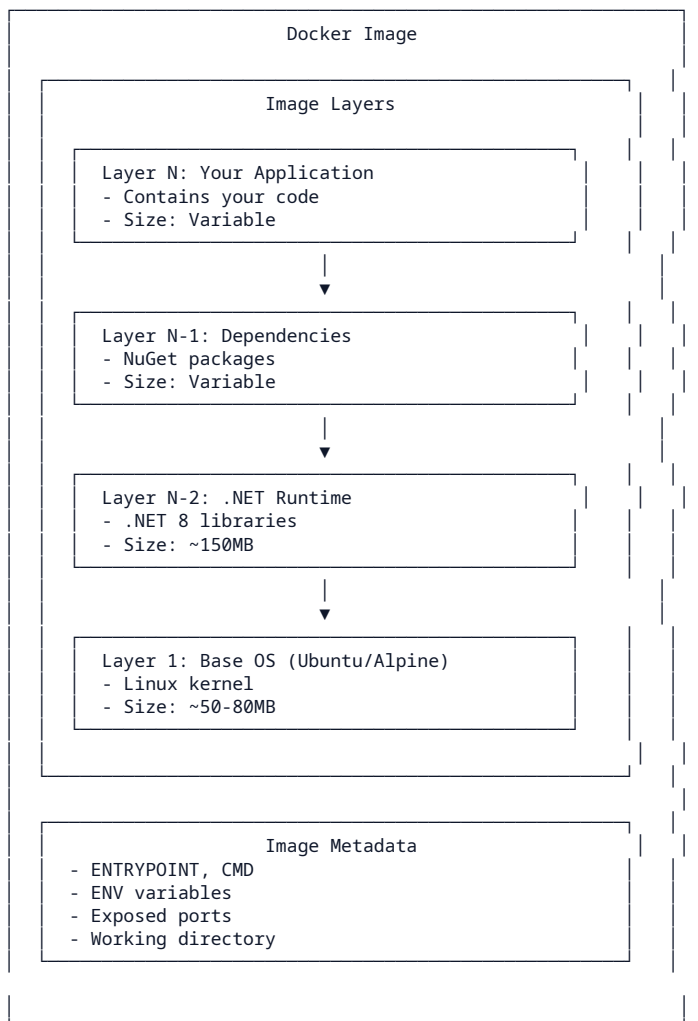


Image Storage Location:

```
# Windows
C:\ProgramData\docker\windowsfilter\

# Linux
/var/lib/docker/image/

# Mac
~/Library/Containers/com.docker.docker/Data/vms/0/
```

Topic 2: Base Image

Definition: Base image root layer hai jo Docker image build karne ke liye starting point provide karta hai. Yeh usually OS ya programming language runtime hota hai.

Base Image Examples:

```
# .NET Base Images
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:8.0
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:6.0
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:6.0

# .NET 8 runtime
# .NET 8 SDK (for building)
# .NET 6 runtime
# .NET 6 SDK

# OS Base Images
```

```
FROM ubuntu:22.04           # Ubuntu Linux
FROM alpine:3.19            # Minimal Alpine Linux
FROM debian:bookworm       # Debian Linux
FROM windowsservercore:ltsc2022 # Windows Server Core

# Language Runtime
FROM node:20-alpine        # Node.js 20
FROM python:3.12-slim      # Python 3.12
FROM openjdk:17-slim       # Java 17
FROM ruby:3.3-alpine       # Ruby 3.3
```

Alpine vs Ubuntu:

Alpine:

- Very small (~5MB base)
- Uses musl libc (not glibc)
- May have compatibility issues with some software
- Good for production (small size)

Ubuntu:

- Larger (~80MB base)
- Uses glibc (widely compatible)
- More packages available
- Good for development (compatibility)

For .NET Developer:

```
# Development - Can use larger image for tools
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:8.0 AS build
RUN dotnet build

# Production - Use smaller runtime image
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0 AS runtime
# Only runtime, no build tools
```

Topic 3: Official Image

Definition: Official images Docker Hub par verify kiye gaye images hain jo Docker maintain karta hai. Yeh security audited aur optimized hain.

Official Image Characteristics:

```
Docker Verified Publisher
Regular security updates
Clear documentation
Good practices followed
Community supported
```

Official Image Examples:

```
# .NET Official Images
mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0
mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:8.0
mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest

# Other Official Images
nginx:latest
redis:7-alpine
postgres:16
mysql:8.0
node:20-alpine
python:3.12-slim
```

How to Identify Official Images:

Docker Hub website:

- Shows "OFFICIAL IMAGE" badge
- Verified publisher badge

Docker search:

docker search nginx

Output shows OFFICIAL column

#	NAME	DESCRIPTION	STARS	OFFICIAL
#	nginx	...	15000	[OK]
#	bitnami/nginx	...	500	[]

Using Official Images:

```
# Safe to use for production
```

```
docker pull mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0

# Always specify version, not just :latest
docker pull mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0.0
```

Topic 4: Custom Image

Definition: Custom image aap khud banate ho apne application ke liye. Yeh official image par base hota hai aur aapke code aur dependencies contain karta hai.

Creating Custom Image:

```
# Step 1: Start from base image
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0

# Step 2: Set working directory
WORKDIR /app

# Step 3: Copy application files
COPY . /app

# Step 4: Set environment
ENV ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production

# Step 5: Set entry point
ENTRYPOINT ["dotnet", "MyApp.dll"]
```

Build Custom Image:

```
# Build with default tag
docker build -t myapp .

# Build with version
docker build -t myapp:v1.0.0 .

# Build with registry prefix
docker build -t myregistry.azurecr.io/myapp:v1.0.0 .
```

Push to Registry:

```
# Tag for registry
docker tag myapp:v1.0.0 myusername/myapp:v1.0.0

# Push to Docker Hub
docker push myusername/myapp:v1.0.0

# Push to private registry
docker push myregistry.azurecr.io/myapp:v1.0.0
```

Topic 5: Image Caching

Definition: Docker build process mein layers cache karta hai. Agar layer unchanged hai, toh Docker cached version use karta hai jo build ko fast banata hai.

How Caching Works:

```
# Dockerfile
FROM ubuntu:22.04
WORKDIR /app
COPY package.json .
RUN npm install
COPY . .

# Layer 1: Cached
# Layer 2: Cached
# Layer 3: Cached (if unchanged)
# Layer 4: Cached (if unchanged)
# Layer 5: Rebuilt (changed!)
```

Cache Optimization:

```
# Good - Copy deps first, then code
FROM node:20
WORKDIR /app

# Copy package files first (rarely change)
COPY package*.json ./
RUN npm ci

# Copy rest of code (changes often)
COPY . .
```

```
RUN npm run build
```

```
# Good - Use specific versions
FROM node:20.11.0 # Not just "20"
```

```
# Bad - Copy everything at once
FROM node:20
COPY . . # Any code change rebuilds everything
RUN npm install
```

Cache Busting:

```
# Force no-cache for specific stage
docker build --no-cache .
```

```
# Clear build cache
docker builder prune -a
```

Topic 6: Image Digest

Definition: Image digest SHA256 hash hai jo image content uniquely identify karta hai. Yeh tag se alag hai kyunki tag change ho sakta hai, digest nahi.

Why Digest Matters:

Tag can change:

- nginx:latest → New version might be pushed
- You pulled yesterday → Different from today?

Digest is immutable:

- sha256:abc123... → Always same content
- Can't be changed without new digest

View Digest:

```
# Pull and view digest
docker pull nginx@sha256:abc123...

# Inspect image digest
docker inspect --format='{{index .RepoDigests 0}}' nginx:latest

# Output:
# nginx@sha256:abc123def456...
```

Using Digest for Reproducibility:

```
# Instead of tag, use digest for exact image
FROM nginx@sha256:abc123def456...

# This guarantees exact same image everywhere
# No surprise updates!
```

Topic 7: Save and Load Images

Save Image to File:

```
# Save image to tar file
docker save -o myapp.tar myapp:v1.0.0

# Save multiple images
docker save -o images.tar image1:v1 image2:v1

# Compress while saving
docker save myapp:v1 | gzip > myapp.tar.gz
```

Load Image from File:

```
# Load from tar file
docker load -i myapp.tar

# Load from compressed file
docker load -i myapp.tar.gz

# Or with pipe
gunzip -c myapp.tar.gz | docker load
```

Use Cases:

```
# Share image without registry
# Machine A: Save and copy to USB
docker save myapp:v1 -o myapp.tar
# Copy myapp.tar to another machine

# Machine B: Load from USB
docker load -i myapp.tar

# Air-gapped environment (no internet)
# Build on development machine, transfer to production
```

Topic 8: Push Image to Registry

Push to Docker Hub:

```
# 1. Login to Docker Hub
docker login

# 2. Tag image with username
docker tag myapp:v1.0.0 yourusername/myapp:v1.0.0

# 3. Push image
docker push yourusername/myapp:v1.0.0

# 4. Also push :latest
docker tag myapp:v1.0.0 yourusername/myapp:latest
docker push yourusername/myapp:latest
```

Push to AWS ECR:

```
# 1. Get ECR login password
aws ecr get-login-password --region us-east-1 | \
docker login --username AWS --password-stdin \
123456789012.dkr.ecr.us-east-1.amazonaws.com

# 2. Tag image
docker tag myapp:v1.0.0 \
123456789012.dkr.ecr.us-east-1.amazonaws.com/myapp:v1.0.0

# 3. Push image
docker push \
123456789012.dkr.ecr.us-east-1.amazonaws.com/myapp:v1.0.0
```

Push to Azure Container Registry:

```
# 1. Login
docker login myregistry.azurecr.io

# 2. Tag
docker tag myapp:v1.0.0 myregistry.azurecr.io/myapp:v1.0.0

# 3. Push
docker push myregistry.azurecr.io/myapp:v1.0.0
```

Topic 9: Image Security Scanning

Why Scan:

Vulnerabilities in images can:

- Expose sensitive data
- Allow unauthorized access
- Compromise entire system
- Lead to data breaches

Regular scanning prevents these!

Scan with Docker Scout:

```
# Enable Docker Scout (Docker Desktop Pro+)
docker scout cves myapp:v1

# View vulnerabilities
docker scout recommendations myapp:v1
```

Scan with Trivy:

```
# Install Trivy
docker run aquasec/trivy --version

# Scan image
docker run aquasec/trivy image myapp:v1

# Scan with output
docker run aquasec/trivy image --format json myapp:v1 > scan.json
```

Security Best Practices:

```
# Use specific versions
FROM node:20.11.0 # Not just "20"

# Use minimal images
FROM node:20-alpine # Smaller = fewer vulnerabilities

# Don't run as root
RUN addgroup -S appgroup && adduser -S appuser -G appgroup
USER appuser

# No secrets in image
# ENV API_KEY=secret # Don't do this!
# Use secrets at runtime: docker run -e API_KEY=$API_KEY
```

Topic 10: Private vs Public Images

Public Images:

- Free to pull
- Anyone can use
- Good for open source
- Security risk (anyone can push)
- Not for proprietary apps

Private Images:

- Only authorized users can pull
- Good for proprietary code
- Secure for business apps
- Requires authentication
- May have storage costs

Pull Private Image:

```
# Login first
docker login

# Then pull
docker pull myregistry.azurecr.io/private-app:v1

# Or with credentials
docker pull username/private-app:v1
```

Best Practice:

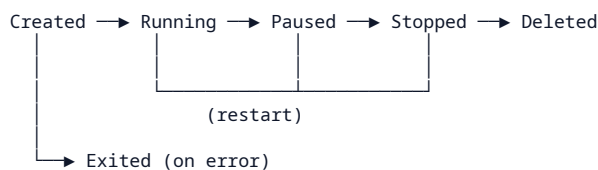
```
# Public base images: Fine
docker pull nginx:latest
docker pull mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0

# Private application images: Use private registry
# AWS ECR, Azure ACR, Google Artifact Registry
```

LEVEL 6: Docker Container Deep Learning

Topic 1: Container Lifecycle States

State Diagram:



State Details:

Created: Container exists but not started
`docker create nginx`
 # Status: Created

Running: Container is executing
`docker start mycontainer`
 # Status: Up 5 minutes

Paused: Container processes suspended
`docker pause mycontainer`
 # Status: Paused

Stopped: Container exited gracefully
`docker stop mycontainer`
 # Status: Exited (0)

Killed: Container terminated forcefully
`docker kill mycontainer`
 # Status: Exited (137)

Restarting: Container is restarting
`docker restart mycontainer`
 # Status: Restarting

Exit Codes:

Exit 0: Successful exit, no errors
 Exit 1: Application error (general)
 Exit 137: SIGKILL (usually OOM - Out of Memory)
 Exit 139: SIGSEGV (Segmentation fault)
 Exit 143: SIGTERM (Graceful shutdown)

Topic 2: Container Modes

Detached Mode (-d):

Run in background
`docker run -d --name mynginx nginx`

Check it's running
`docker ps`

# CONTAINER ID	IMAGE	STATUS	PORTS	NAMES
abc123	nginx	Up 5 secs		mynginx

Container continues running after terminal closes

Interactive Mode (-it):

Interactive with terminal
`docker run -it ubuntu bash`
 # root@abc123:/#

Run command and exit
`docker run -it ubuntu echo "Hello"`
 # Output: Hello

-i: Keep STDIN open
 # -t: Allocate pseudo-TTY

Combined Modes:


```
# Detached + Interactive (for debugging)
docker run -d -it --name debug-container ubuntu bash

# Attach later
docker attach debug-container

# Exit without stopping: Ctrl+P, Ctrl+Q
```

One-off Commands:

```
# Run command in existing container
docker exec mycontainer ls /app

# Interactive shell
docker exec -it mycontainer bash

# Run and remove (one-off task)
docker run --rm alpine echo "Done"
```

Topic 3: Container Restart Policies

Why Restart Policy:

Without policy:

- Container crashes → stays stopped
- No automatic recovery
- Manual intervention needed

With restart policy:

- Container crashes → automatically restarts
- Self-healing
- Always running services

Available Policies:

```
# no - Never restart (default)
docker run -d --restart no nginx

# always - Always restart
docker run -d --restart always nginx

# on-failure - Restart only on error (non-zero exit)
docker run -d --restart on-failure nginx

# on-failure:3 - Restart on error, max 3 retries
docker run -d --restart on-failure:3 nginx

# unless-stopped - Restart unless manually stopped
docker run -d --restart unless-stopped nginx
```

Restart Policy Comparison:

```
# Use in docker-compose.yml
services:
  api:
    restart: "no"           # Don't restart
    # Use: Batch jobs, one-time tasks

  web:
    restart: "always"       # Always restart
    # Use: Web servers, APIs

  worker:
    restart: "on-failure"    # Restart on error
    # Use: Background workers, jobs

  critical:
    restart: "unless-stopped" # Restart unless stopped
    # Use: Databases, critical services
```

Topic 4: Container Resource Limits

CPU Limits:

```
# Limit to 1 CPU core
docker run -d --cpus="1.0" myapi

# Limit to 0.5 CPU (half core)
```

```
docker run -d --cpus="0.5" myapi
```

```
# Limit specific cores
```

```
docker run -d --cpuset-cpus="0,1" myapi
```

Memory Limits:

```
# Limit to 512 MB
```

```
docker run -d --memory="512m" myapi
```

```
# Limit to 1 GB
```

```
docker run -d --memory="1g" myapi
```

```
# Limit with swap
```

```
docker run -d --memory="512m" --memory-swap="1g" myapi
```

```
# Memory + CPU
```

```
docker run -d \  
  --memory="1g" \  
  --cpus="2" \  
  myapi
```

View Resource Usage:

```
# Real-time stats
```

```
docker stats
```

```
# Stats for specific container
```

```
docker stats myapi
```

```
# All containers stats
```

```
docker stats $(docker ps --format '{{.Names}}')
```

```
# Inspect limits
```

```
docker inspect --format='{{json .HostConfig.Memory}}' myapi
```

docker-compose.yml Resources:

```
services:
```

```
  api:
```

```
    image: myapi
```

```
    deploy:
```

```
      resources:
```

```
        limits:
```

```
          cpus: '1.0'
```

```
          memory: 1G
```

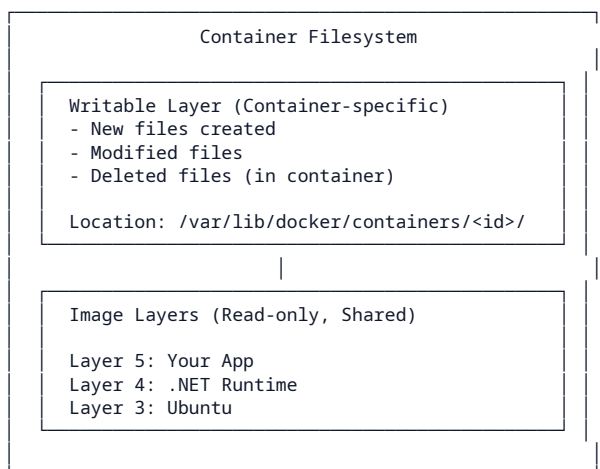
```
        reservations:
```

```
          cpus: '0.5'
```

```
          memory: 512M
```

Topic 5: Container Filesystem

Filesystem Layers:



Copy Files To/From Container:

```
# Copy from host to container
```

```
docker cp ./config.json myapi:/app/config.json
```

```
# Copy from container to host
docker cp myapi:/app/logs ./logs

# Copy entire folder
docker cp myapi:/app/. ./local-app
```

Inspect Filesystem:

```
# Enter container and explore
docker exec -it myapi bash

# Check directory structure
ls -la /app

# Check disk usage
df -h

# Check specific folder size
du -sh /app
```

Topic 6: Container Health Checks

Why Health Check:

Without health check:

- Container running even if app crashed
- Load balancer sends traffic to dead container
- No automatic recovery

With health check:

- Docker tests if app is healthy
- Unhealthy containers marked
- Can auto-restart or remove from load balancer

Dockerfile HEALTHCHECK:

```
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0
WORKDIR /app
COPY . .

# Health check - test /health endpoint
HEALTHCHECK --interval=30s --timeout=10s --retries=3 \
  CMD curl -f http://localhost:5000/health || exit 1

ENTRYPOINT ["dotnet", "MyApp.dll"]
```

Add Health Endpoint in .NET:

```
// Program.cs
app.MapGet("/health", () => Results.Ok(new
{
    status = "healthy",
    timestamp = DateTime.UtcNow
}));
```

docker-compose.yml Health Check:

```
services:
  api:
    build: .
    healthcheck:
      test: ["CMD", "curl", "-f", "http://localhost:5000/health"]
      interval: 30s
      timeout: 10s
      retries: 3
      start_period: 40s
    ports:
      - "5000:5000"
```

Check Health Status:

```
# View health status
docker inspect --format='{{.State.Health.Status}}' myapi

# Possible values: starting, healthy, unhealthy
```

Topic 7: Container Hostname and DNS

Default Hostname:

```
# Container hostname defaults to container ID (short)
docker run -d --name myapi nginx
docker exec myapi hostname
# Output: abc123def456

# Custom hostname
docker run -d --name myapi --hostname myapi-host nginx
docker exec myapi hostname
# Output: myapi-host
```

Docker DNS:

```
# Containers can resolve each other by name
docker network create mynet
docker run -d --network mynet --name api myapi
docker run -d --network mynet --name db mysql

# From api container, access db by name
docker exec api ping db
# Pings successfully!

# Also works with aliases
docker run -d --network mynet --name api --network-alias api-svc myapi
# Can be accessed as both "api" and "api-svc"
```

DNS Resolution Order:

1. Container's own hostname
 2. Network aliases
 3. Container name (if on same network)
 4. Built-in DNS server (127.0.0.11)
-

Topic 8: Container Isolation

Namespace Isolation:

PID Namespace:	Each container sees only its own processes
NET Namespace:	Each container has its own network stack
IPC Namespace:	Each container has its own IPC resources
MNT Namespace:	Each container has its own filesystem view
UTS Namespace:	Each container has its own hostname
USER Namespace:	Each container has its own user IDs

Process Isolation:

```
# Host sees container process
ps aux | grep nginx
# Shows nginx process running

# But inside container
docker exec mynginx ps aux
# Only shows processes inside container
# Host processes not visible
```

Network Isolation:

```
# Container has own network
docker exec mynginx ip addr
# Shows: lo, eth0 (container's network)

# Container can't see host network
docker exec mynginx ip link show docker0 # Won't work
```

Filesystem Isolation:

```
# Container can't see host files (unless bind mounted)
docker run -it ubuntu ls /host
# ls: cannot access '/host': No such file or directory
```

Topic 9: Container Communication

Same Network:

```
# Create network
```

```
docker network create mynet

# Run containers on same network
docker run -d --network mynet --name api myapi
docker run -d --network mynet --name db sqlserver

# From api to db - use container name as hostname
# Connection string: Server=db;Database=MyDb;...
# "db" resolves to db container's IP
```

Different Networks:

```
# Container on multiple networks
docker network connect mynet api
docker network disconnect mynet api

# Inspect networks
docker inspect myapi --format='{{json .NetworkSettings.Networks}}'
```

Ports vs Network:

Ports (docker run -p 8080:5000):

- Expose container port to host
- External users access via host:8080

Network:

- Container-to-container communication
- Containers on same network talk to each other
- No external access required

Topic 10: Ephemeral Nature of Container

What Gets Lost:

When container is deleted:

- Files created inside container
- Modified configuration
- Database data (without volume)
- Application logs
- Any runtime changes

Data in volumes: Saved
Data in bind mounts: Saved

What Persists:

- Images (stored separately)
- Named volumes
- Bind mount host directories
- Image layers (read-only)

Example - Data Loss:

```
# Create file in container
docker run -d --name test nginx
docker exec test touch /app/data.txt
docker exec test ls /app
# Shows: data.txt

# Delete container - DATA LOST!
docker rm -f test

# Create new container
docker run -d --name test2 nginx
docker exec test2 ls /app
# No data.txt - it's gone!
```

Solution - Use Volumes:

```
# Create volume
docker volume create mydata

# Use volume
docker run -d --name test -v mydata:/app nginx

# Create file in volume
docker exec test touch /app/data.txt

# Delete container - Data preserved!
docker rm -f test
```

```
# New container with same volume - Data there!  
docker run -d --name test2 -v mydata:/app nginx  
docker exec test2 ls /app  
# Shows: data.txt
```

LEVEL 7: Dockerfile Basics

Complete Dockerfile Instructions

FROM Instruction

Purpose: Base image define karta hai.

```
# Official .NET image
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0
```

```
# Official OS
FROM ubuntu:22.04
```

```
# With alias (for multi-stage)
FROM ubuntu:22.04 AS build
```

WORKDIR Instruction

Purpose: Working directory set karta hai.

```
# Set working directory
WORKDIR /app
```

```
# Creates directory if doesn't exist
WORKDIR /app/src # Creates both /app and /app/src
```

```
# Can use environment variables
WORKDIR $APP_HOME
```

COPY Instruction

Purpose: Files copy karta hai from build context to image.

```
# Copy all files
COPY . /app
```

```
# Copy specific file
COPY appsettings.json /app/
```

```
# Copy with destination
COPY ./src /app/src
```

```
# Copy with ownership (Linux)
COPY --chown=appuser:appgroup . /app
```

ADD Instruction

Purpose: COPY se similar but URLs aur archives handle kar sakta hai.

```
# Add remote URL (use COPY instead when possible)
ADD https://example.com/file.zip /app/
```

```
# Extract tar file (automatically)
ADD myapp.tar.gz /app/
```

```
# COPY is preferred for regular files (faster, more predictable)
```

RUN Instruction

Purpose: Commands execute karta hai during build.

```
# Shell form
RUN echo "Hello"
```

```
# Exec form (preferred)
RUN ["echo", "Hello"]
```

```
# Chained commands (reduces layers)
RUN apt-get update && \
    apt-get install -y curl && \
    apt-get clean
```

```
# .NET specific
RUN dotnet restore
RUN dotnet build -c Release
```

CMD Instruction

Purpose: Default command jo container start hote waqt run hoga.

```
# Exec form (preferred)
CMD ["dotnet", "MyApp.dll"]

# With arguments
CMD ["dotnet", "run", "--configuration", "Release"]

# Shell form (not recommended)
CMD echo "Container started"
```

ENTRYPOINT Instruction

Purpose: Main executable define karta hai.

```
# Exec form
ENTRYPOINT ["dotnet", "MyApp.dll"]

# Shell form
ENTRYPOINT dotnet MyApp.dll
```

EXPOSE Instruction

Purpose: Documentation ke liye port define karta hai.

```
EXPOSE 5000
EXPOSE 80 443
EXPOSE 8080 8443
```

ENV Instruction

Purpose: Environment variable set karta hai.

```
# Single variable
ENV ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production

# Multiple variables
ENV APP_NAME=MyApp \
  APP_VERSION=1.0.0 \
  APP_ENV=Production

# Use in commands
RUN echo $APP_NAME
```

ARG Instruction

Purpose: Build-time variables (not available at runtime).

```
# Define argument
ARG VERSION=1.0

# Use in build
RUN echo "Building version $VERSION"

# Pass at build time
# docker build --build-arg VERSION=2.0 .
```

USER Instruction

Purpose: User set karta hai for subsequent commands.

```
# Create user
RUN groupadd -r appgroup && useradd -r -g appgroup appuser

# Set user
USER appuser
```

VOLUME Instruction

Purpose: Volume mount point declare karta hai.

```
VOLUME ["/app/data"]
VOLUME ["/app/logs", "/app/config"]
```


HEALTHCHECK Instruction

Purpose: Container health check define karta hai.

```
HEALTHCHECK --interval=30s --timeout=3s --retries=3 \
  CMD curl -f http://localhost:5000/health || exit 1
```

LABEL Instruction

Purpose: Metadata add karta hai.

```
LABEL version="1.0"
LABEL description="My application"
LABEL maintainer="email@example.com"
```

LEVEL 8: Dockerfile for .NET Developer

Complete .NET Dockerfiles

Dockerfile for .NET Console App

```
# =====
# Stage 1: Build
# =====
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:8.0 AS build

# Set working directory
WORKDIR /src

# Copy project file and restore dependencies
COPY ["ConsoleApp.csproj", "."]
RUN dotnet restore

# Copy all source files
COPY . .

# Build the application
RUN dotnet build -c Release -o /app/build

# Publish the application
RUN dotnet publish -c Release -o /app/publish

# =====
# Stage 2: Runtime
# =====
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/runtime:8.0 AS runtime

# Set working directory
WORKDIR /app

# Copy published output from build stage
COPY --from=build /app/publish .

# Non-root user for security
RUN groupadd -r appgroup && \
    useradd -r -g appgroup appuser && \
    chown -R appuser:appgroup /app

USER appuser

# Run the application
ENTRYPOINT ["dotnet", "ConsoleApp.dll"]
```

Dockerfile for ASP.NET Core Web API

```
# =====
# Stage 1: Build
# =====
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:8.0 AS build

WORKDIR /src

# Copy and restore (order matters for caching!)
COPY ["MyApi.csproj", "."]
RUN dotnet restore

# Copy source and build
COPY . .
RUN dotnet build -c Release --no-restore -o /app/build

# Publish
RUN dotnet publish -c Release --no-restore -o /app/publish

# =====
# Stage 2: Runtime
# =====
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0 AS runtime

WORKDIR /app

# Copy published files
COPY --from=build /app/publish .

# Environment variables
ENV ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production
```

```
ENV ASPNETCORE_URLS=http://+:5000

# Expose port
EXPOSE 5000

# Set ownership
RUN chown -R appuser:appgroup /app 2>/dev/null || true

# Run the application
ENTRYPOINT ["dotnet", "MyApi.dll"]
```

Dockerfile for ASP.NET Core MVC

```
# Build stage
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:8.0 AS build
WORKDIR /src

COPY *.csproj ./
RUN dotnet restore

COPY . .
RUN dotnet build -c Release --no-restore -o /app/build

RUN dotnet publish -c Release --no-restore -o /app/publish

# Runtime stage
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0 AS runtime
WORKDIR /app

COPY --from=build /app/publish .

ENV ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production
ENV ASPNETCORE_URLS=http://+:80

EXPOSE 80

ENTRYPOINT ["dotnet", "MyMvcApp.dll"]
```

Dockerfile for Worker Service

```
# Build stage
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:8.0 AS build
WORKDIR /src

COPY *.csproj ./
RUN dotnet restore

COPY . .
RUN dotnet publish -c Release --no-restore -o /app/publish

# Runtime stage
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/aspnet:8.0 AS runtime
WORKDIR /app

COPY --from=build /app/publish .

# No port exposed (background worker)
ENV DOTNET_RUNNING_IN_CONTAINER=true

ENTRYPOINT ["dotnet", "MyWorker.dll"]
```

Development Dockerfile

```
# For development with hot reload
FROM mcr.microsoft.com/dotnet/sdk:8.0 AS development

WORKDIR /src

# Mount source for hot reload
COPY . .

# Expose ports
EXPOSE 5000 5001

# Run in development mode
CMD ["dotnet", "watch", "run"]
```

.dockerignore File

```
# Git
.git
.gitignore
```

```
# Build outputs - IMPORTANT!
bin/
obj/
out/
publish/

# IDE
.vs/
.vscode/
*.user
*.suo

# Logs
*.log
logs/

# Test
TestResults/
coverage/

# Docker
Dockerfile*
docker-compose*
.dockerignore

# OS
Thumbs.db
.DS_Store

# Secrets
*.key
*.pem
appsettings.*.json
```

LEVEL 9: Docker Port Mapping

Complete Port Mapping Guide

Port Mapping Syntax

```
# Basic syntax
-p host_port:container_port

# Examples
-p 8080:5000    # Host 8080 → Container 5000
-p 443:443      # Same port both sides
-p 5000:5000    # Same port both sides

# Multiple ports
-p 8080:5000 -p 443:5001

# Bind to specific host IP
-p 127.0.0.1:8080:5000

# UDP port
-p 53:53/udp
```

Common Ports Reference

```
# .NET Applications
-p 5000:5000    # HTTP (Kestrel)
-p 5001:5001    # HTTPS (Kestrel alternative)
-p 8080:5000    # Common HTTP mapping

# SQL Server
-p 1433:1433    # Default SQL Server port

# PostgreSQL
-p 5432:5432    # Default PostgreSQL port

# MySQL
-p 3306:3306    # Default MySQL port

# Redis
-p 6379:6379    # Default Redis port

# MongoDB
-p 27017:27017  # Default MongoDB port

# RabbitMQ
-p 5672:5672    # AMQP
-p 15672:15672  # Management UI

# Nginx
-p 80:80        # HTTP
-p 443:443      # HTTPS

# Elasticsearch
-p 9200:9200    # REST API
-p 9300:9300    # Transport
```

Port Mapping in Docker Compose

```
services:
  api:
    ports:
      - "8080:5000"    # Host 8080 → Container 5000
      - "5001:5001"    # HTTPS
      - "127.0.0.1:8081:5000" # Bind to localhost only

  database:
    ports:
      - "1433:1433"

  redis:
    ports:
      - "6379:6379"
```

Port Conflicts

```
# Error: port is already in use
# Solution 1: Use different host port
docker run -d -p 8081:5000 myapi
```

```
# Solution 2: Find and stop conflicting process
netstat -ano | findstr :8080
# Kill the process using port 8080

# Solution 3: Check what's using port
docker ps --format '{{.Ports}}'
# Shows all port mappings

# View published ports
docker port mycontainer
```

Port Mapping Verification

```
# Check port mapping for a container
docker port myapi
# Output: 5000/tcp -> 0.0.0.0:8080

# List all port mappings
docker ps --format "table {{.Names}}\t{{.Ports}}"

# Test connectivity
curl http://localhost:8080/api/health

# Check if port is listening
docker exec myapi netstat -tlnp | grep 5000
```

LEVEL 10: Docker Volumes

Complete Volume Guide

Volume Types

Named Volume:

```
# Create
docker volume create mydata

# Use
docker run -d -v mydata:/app/data myapi

# All data in /app/data persists even after container delete
```

Bind Mount:

```
# Map host directory to container
docker run -d -v C:\Projects\MyApp:/app myapi

# Linux/Mac
docker run -d -v /home/user/projects:/app myapi

# Read-only bind mount
docker run -d -v C:\Projects\MyApp:/app:ro myapi
```

tmpfs Mount (memory only):

```
# Store sensitive data in memory (not on disk)
docker run -d --tmpfs /app/secrets:rw myapi

# With size limit
docker run -d --tmpfs /app/secrets:size=100m myapi
```

Volume Commands

```
# Create volume
docker volume create myvolume

# List volumes
docker volume ls

# Inspect volume
docker volume inspect myvolume

# Remove volume
docker volume rm myvolume

# Remove all unused volumes
docker volume prune

# Remove all volumes ( Data loss!)
docker volume prune -a
```

Volume with SQL Server

```
# Run SQL Server with volume
docker run -d \
  --name sqlserver \
  -e "ACCEPT_EULA=Y" \
  -e "SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd" \
  -v sqldata:/var/opt/mssql \
  -p 1433:1433 \
  mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest

# Data persists:
# /var/opt/mssql in container → sqldata volume
```

Volume with PostgreSQL

```
docker run -d \
  --name postgres \
  -e POSTGRES_PASSWORD=secret \
  -v pgdata:/var/lib/postgresql/data \
  -p 5432:5432 \
  postgres:16
```

Volume with MongoDB

```
docker run -d \  
  --name mongodb \  
  -e MONGO_INITDB_ROOT_USERNAME=admin \  
  -e MONGO_INITDB_ROOT_PASSWORD=secret \  
  -v mongodata:/data/db \  
  -p 27017:27017 \  
  mongo:7
```

Backup and Restore

```
# Backup volume  
docker run --rm \  
  -v sqldata:/data \  
  -v $(pwd):/backup \  
  alpine \  
  tar czf /backup/backup.tar.gz -C /data .
```

```
# Restore volume  
docker volume create sqldata  
docker run --rm \  
  -v sqldata:/data \  
  -v $(pwd):/backup \  
  alpine \  
  tar xzf /backup/backup.tar.gz -C /data
```

Volume Permissions

```
# Common issue: Permission denied  
# Solution 1: Create directory first  
mkdir -p ./data  
chmod 777 ./data
```

```
# Solution 2: Use named volume (Docker manages permissions)  
docker run -v myvolume:/app/data myapi
```

```
# Solution 3: Run as root  
docker run -u root -v $(pwd):/app myapi
```

```
# Solution 4: Fix in Dockerfile  
RUN chmod -R 755 /app/data
```

LEVEL 11: Docker Networking

Complete Networking Guide

Network Types

Bridge Network (Default):

```
# Default bridge - all containers can communicate via IP
docker run -d --name api myapi
docker run -d --name db mysql

# API can reach DB via IP (but not by name easily)
docker exec api ping 172.17.0.2 # Works
docker exec api ping db        # Doesn't work (default bridge)
```

Custom Bridge Network:

```
# Create custom network
docker network create mynet

# Run containers on custom network
docker run -d --network mynet --name api myapi
docker run -d --network mynet --name db mysql

# Now containers can communicate by name!
docker exec api ping db        # Works!
docker exec db ping api        # Works!
```

Host Network:

```
# Container uses host network directly
docker run -d --network host --name api myapi

# No port mapping needed - container uses host ports directly
# Container app on port 5000 = host port 5000
```

None Network:

```
# No network access
docker run -d --network none --name isolated alpine

# Container cannot communicate with anything
docker exec isolated ping google.com # Won't work
```

Network Commands

```
# List networks
docker network ls

# Create network
docker network create mynet

# Inspect network
docker network inspect mynet

# Connect container to network
docker network connect mynet mycontainer

# Disconnect container from network
docker network disconnect mynet mycontainer

# Remove network
docker network rm mynet

# Remove unused networks
docker network prune
```

Network in Docker Compose

```
version: '3.8'
```

```
services:
  api:
    build: .
    networks:
      - backend
    ports:
```

```
- "8080:5000"

db:
  image: mssql/server:2022
  networks:
    - backend
  volumes:
    - sqldata:/var/opt/mssql

redis:
  image: redis:7
  networks:
    - backend

networks:
  backend:
    driver: bridge
```

Container-to-Container Communication

Scenario: .NET API connecting to SQL Server

Step 1: Create network
docker network create appnet

Step 2: Run SQL Server on network
docker run -d \
 --network appnet \
 --name sqlserver \
 -e "ACCEPT_EULA=Y" \
 -e "SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd" \
 mssql/server:2022-latest

Step 3: Run API on same network
docker run -d \
 --network appnet \
 --name myapi \
 -e "ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=sqlserver;Database=MyDb;User=sa;Password=YourStrong@Passw0rd;TrustServerCertificate=True" \
 -p 8080:5000 \
 myapi

API connects to SQL Server using container name "sqlserver"

DNS and Service Discovery

Docker DNS automatically resolves:
- Container names
- Network aliases
- Container IDs (short and full)

Examples:
docker exec api ping sqlserver # By container name
docker exec api ping db # By alias (if configured)

Connection strings:
Server=sqlserver;Port=1433;... # Container name works!
Server=mydb;... # Host name works!

LEVEL 12: SQL Server with Docker

Complete SQL Server Guide

Run SQL Server Container

```
# Basic SQL Server run
docker run -d \
  --name sqlserver \
  -e "ACCEPT_EULA=Y" \
  -e "SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd" \
  -e "MSSQL_PID=Developer" \
  -p 1433:1433 \
  mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest
```

```
# With volume for data persistence
docker run -d \
  --name sqlserver \
  -e "ACCEPT_EULA=Y" \
  -e "SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd" \
  -e "MSSQL_PID=Developer" \
  -p 1433:1433 \
  -v sqldata:/var/opt/mssql \
  mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest
```

Environment Variables

```
# ACCEPT_EULA - Required! Accept End User License Agreement
ACCEPT_EULA=Y

# SA_PASSWORD - System Administrator password
# Requirements: 8+ chars, uppercase, lowercase, number, special char
SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd

# MSSQL_PID - Product ID
# Values: Developer (free), Express, Standard, Enterprise
MSSQL_PID=Developer

# Additional options
MSSQL_COLLATION=SQL_Latin1_General_CP1_CI_AS
MSSQL_AGENT_ENABLED=true
```

Wait for SQL Server to Start

```
# SQL Server takes 30-60 seconds to start
# Check logs until ready
docker logs -f sqlserver

# Look for: "SQL Server is now ready for client connections"

# Or wait with script
until docker exec -it sqlserver \
  /opt/mssql-tools/bin/sqlcmd \
  -S localhost -U sa -P "YourStrong@Passw0rd" \
  -Q "SELECT 1" > /dev/null 2>&1; do
  echo "Waiting for SQL Server..."
  sleep 5
done
echo "SQL Server is ready!"
```

Connect to SQL Server

From SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS):

```
Server Name: localhost,1433
Authentication: SQL Server Authentication
Login: sa
Password: YourStrong@Passw0rd
```

From Azure Data Studio:

```
Server: localhost,1433
Authentication: SQL Login
User: sa
Password: YourStrong@Passw0rd
```

From .NET Application:

```
// Connection string for Docker SQL Server
"Server=localhost;Database=MyDb;User
Id=sa;Password=YourStrong@Passw0rd;TrustServerCertificate=True;"

// Or using container name (if on same network)
"Server=sqlserver;Database=MyDb;User
Id=sa;Password=YourStrong@Passw0rd;TrustServerCertificate=True;"
```

Run SQL Commands

```
# Connect via sqlcmd
docker exec -it sqlserver /opt/mssql-tools/bin/sqlcmd \
-S localhost -U sa -P "YourStrong@Passw0rd"

# List databases
SELECT name FROM sys.databases;
GO

# Create database
CREATE DATABASE MyAppDB;
GO

# Use database
USE MyAppDB;
GO

# Create table
CREATE TABLE Products (
    Id INT PRIMARY KEY,
    Name NVARCHAR(100),
    Price DECIMAL(18,2)
);
GO

# Insert data
INSERT INTO Products VALUES (1, 'Laptop', 999.99);
GO

# Select data
SELECT * FROM Products;
GO

# Exit
EXIT
```

Docker Compose with SQL Server

```
version: '3.8'

services:
  api:
    build: .
    ports:
      - "8080:5000"
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Development
      - ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=sqlserver;Database=MyAppDB;User=sa;Password=YourStrong@Passw0rd;TrustServerCertificate=True;
    depends_on:
      - sqlserver
    networks:
      - appnet

  sqlserver:
    image: mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest
    environment:
      - ACCEPT_EULA=Y
      - SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd
      - MSSQL_PID=Developer
    ports:
      - "1433:1433"
    volumes:
      - sqldata:/var/opt/mssql
    networks:
      - appnet

networks:
  appnet:
    driver: bridge

volumes:
  sqldata:
```

Health Check for SQL Server

```
services:
  sqlserver:
    image: mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest
    environment:
      - ACCEPT_EULA=Y
      - SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd
    healthcheck:
      test: ["CMD-SHELL", "/opt/mssql-tools/bin/sqlcmd -S localhost -U sa -P  
        'YourStrong@Passw0rd' -Q 'SELECT 1'"]
      interval: 30s
      timeout: 10s
      retries: 5
      start_period: 60s
```

LEVEL 13: Docker Compose Basics

Complete Docker Compose Guide

docker-compose.yml Structure

```
version: '3.8' # Docker Compose file format version

services: # Define all containers
  servicename:
    image: imagename           # Image to use
    build: ./path              # OR Build from Dockerfile
    container_name: myname     # Custom container name
    ports:                     # Port mappings
      - "8080:5000"
    environment:              # Environment variables
      - KEY=value
    volumes:                   # Volume mounts
      - myvol:/app/data
    networks:                  # Network configuration
      - mynet
    depends_on:                # Dependency
      - database
    restart: always            # Restart policy
    healthcheck:               # Health check
      test: ["CMD", "curl", "-f", "http://localhost:5000/health"]

networks: # Define networks
  mynet:
    driver: bridge

volumes: # Define volumes
  myvol:
```

Basic Commands

```
# Start all services
docker compose up

# Start in detached mode
docker compose up -d

# Start with rebuild
docker compose up --build

# Stop all services
docker compose down

# Stop and remove volumes
docker compose down -v

# Stop and remove images
docker compose down --rmi all

# View running services
docker compose ps

# View logs
docker compose logs

# Follow logs
docker compose logs -f

# Execute command in service
docker compose exec api bash

# Run specific command
docker compose exec api dotnet ef database update

# Build images
docker compose build

# Restart services
docker compose restart

# Scale service
docker compose up -d --scale api=3

# Show running processes
docker compose top
```

Environment Variables

```
services:
  api:
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production
      - DB_HOST=sqlserver
      - DB_PORT=1433
      - ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=sqlserver;Database=MyDb;...
```

Volumes in Compose

```
services:
  api:
    volumes:
      - ./logs:/app/logs          # Bind mount
      - apidata:/app/data         # Named volume

  sqlserver:
    volumes:
      - sqldata:/var/opt/mssql

volumes:
  apidata:
  sqldata:
```

Networks in Compose

```
services:
  api:
    networks:
      - frontend
      - backend

  db:
    networks:
      - backend

networks:
  frontend:
    driver: bridge
  backend:
    driver: bridge
```

Restart Policies

```
services:
  api:
    restart: "no"                # Never restart
    # restart: "always"          # Always restart
    # restart: "on-failure"      # Restart on error
    # restart: "unless-stopped"  # Restart unless stopped
```

Complete Example

```
version: '3.8'

services:
  api:
    build:
      context: ./MyApi
      dockerfile: Dockerfile
    container_name: myapi
    ports:
      - "8080:5000"
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Development
      - ASPNETCORE_URLS=http://+:5000
      - ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=sqlserver;Database=MyAppDB;User=sa;Password=YourStrong@Passw0rd;TrustServerCertificate=True;
    depends_on:
      sqlserver:
        condition: service_healthy
    volumes:
      - ./MyApi/logs:/app/logs
    networks:
      - appnet

  sqlserver:
    image: mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest
    container_name: sqlserver
    environment:
```

```
- ACCEPT_EULA=Y
- SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd
- MSSQL_PID=Developer
ports:
  - "1433:1433"
volumes:
  - sqldata:/var/opt/mssql
networks:
  - appnet
healthcheck:
  test: ["CMD-SHELL", "/opt/mssql-tools/bin/sqlcmd -S localhost -U sa -P
    'YourStrong@Passw0rd' -Q 'SELECT 1'"]
  interval: 30s
  timeout: 10s
  retries: 5
  start_period: 60s

networks:
  appnet:
    driver: bridge

volumes:
  sqldata:
```

LEVEL 14: Docker Compose for .NET Project

Complete .NET Project Setup

Full docker-compose.yml for ASP.NET Core API + SQL Server

```
version: '3.8'

services:
  # =====
  # ASP.NET Core Web API
  # =====
  api:
    build:
      context: ./src/MyApi
      dockerfile: Dockerfile
    image: myapi:latest
    container_name: myapi
    ports:
      - "5000:5000"
      - "5001:5001" # HTTPS
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Development
      - ASPNETCORE_URLS=http://+:5000;https://+:5001
      - ASPNETCORE_Kestrel__Certificates__Default__Path=/app/certs/cert.pfx
      - ASPNETCORE_Kestrel__Certificates__Default__Password=password
      - ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=sqlserver;Database=MyAppDB;User=sa;Password=YourStrong@Passw0rd;TrustServerCertificate=True;Encrypt=False
    depends_on:
      sqlserver:
        condition: service_healthy
    volumes:
      - ./src/MyApi/logs:/app/logs
    networks:
      - app-network

  # =====
  # SQL Server Database
  # =====
  sqlserver:
    image: mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest
    container_name: sqlserver
    environment:
      - ACCEPT_EULA=Y
      - SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd
      - MSSQL_PID=Developer
    ports:
      - "1433:1433"
    volumes:
      - sqlserver-data:/var/opt/mssql
    networks:
      - app-network
    healthcheck:
      test: ["CMD-SHELL", "/opt/mssql-tools/bin/sqlcmd -S localhost -U sa -P 'YourStrong@Passw0rd' -Q 'SELECT 1'"]
      interval: 30s
      timeout: 10s
      retries: 5
      start_period: 60s

networks:
  app-network:
    driver: bridge

volumes:
  sqlserver-data:
```

With Redis Cache

```
version: '3.8'

services:
  api:
    build: .
    ports:
      - "5000:5000"
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Development
      - ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=sqlserver;Database=MyAppDB;User=sa;Password=YourStrong@Passw0rd
```

```

    d=YourStrong@Passw0rd;TrustServerCertificate=True;
    - Redis__Host=redis
    - Redis__Port=6379
depends_on:
  - sqlserver
  - redis
networks:
  - app-network

sqlserver:
  image: mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest
  environment:
    - ACCEPT_EULA=Y
    - SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd
  ports:
    - "1433:1433"
  volumes:
    - sqlserver-data:/var/opt/mssql
  networks:
    - app-network

redis:
  image: redis:7-alpine
  ports:
    - "6379:6379"
  volumes:
    - redis-data:/data
  networks:
    - app-network
  command: redis-server --appendonly yes

networks:
  app-network:

    driver: bridge

volumes:
  sqlserver-data:
  redis-data:

```

With Nginx Reverse Proxy

```

version: '3.8'

services:
  nginx:
    image: nginx:alpine
    ports:
      - "80:80"
      - "443:443"
    volumes:
      - ./nginx/nginx.conf:/etc/nginx/nginx.conf:ro
      - ./nginx/certs:/etc/nginx/certs:ro
    depends_on:
      - api
    networks:
      - app-network

  api:
    build: .
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production
    networks:
      - app-network

networks:
  app-network:
    driver: bridge

```

Development vs Production Override

docker-compose.yml (base):

```

version: '3.8'

services:
  api:
    build: .
    ports:
      - "5000:5000"
  sqlserver:
    image: mcr.microsoft.com/mssql/server:2022-latest
    environment:

```

- ACCEPT_EULA=Y
- SA_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd

docker-compose.override.yml (development):

```
version: '3.8'

services:
  api:
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Development
    volumes:
      - ./src:/app/src # Hot reload enabled
    command: dotnet watch run

  sqlserver:
    ports:
      - "1433:1433"
```

docker-compose.prod.yml (production):

```
version: '3.8'

services:
  api:
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production
    restart: always
    healthcheck:
      test: ["CMD", "curl", "-f", "http://localhost:5000/health"]
      interval: 30s
      timeout: 3s
      retries: 3
    deploy:
      resources:
        limits:
          memory: 512M

  sqlserver:
    environment:
      - MSSQL_PID=Standard
    restart: always
```

Run with override:

```
# Development (uses .override.yml automatically)
docker compose up -d

# Production
docker compose -f docker-compose.yml -f docker-compose.prod.yml up -d
```

Running EF Core Migrations

```
# Run migrations
docker compose exec api dotnet ef database update

# Or in code (Program.cs)
using (var scope = app.Services.CreateScope())
{
    var db = scope.ServiceProvider.GetRequiredService<AppDbContext>();
    db.Database.EnsureCreated();
}
```

LEVEL 15: Environment Variables and Configuration

Complete Configuration Guide

Environment Variable Basics

```
# Set single variable
docker run -e ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production myapi

# Set multiple variables
docker run \
  -e ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production \
  -e DB_HOST=sqlserver \
  -e API_KEY=secret123 \
  myapi

# From .env file
docker run --env-file .env myapi

# .env file content:
# ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production
# DB_HOST=sqlserver
# API_KEY=secret123
```

Environment Variables in Dockerfile

```
# Set at build time
ENV ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production
ENV APP_NAME=MyApi
ENV APP_VERSION=1.0.0

# Can override at runtime
docker run -e ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Development myapi
# This overrides the ENV in Dockerfile
```

Environment Variables in Docker Compose

```
services:
  api:
    environment:
      - ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production
      - ASPNETCORE_URLS=http://+:5000
      - ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=sqlserver;Database=MyDb;...

# Or dictionary format
environment:
  ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT: Production
  ASPNETCORE_URLS: http://+:5000

# From env_file
env_file:
  - ./config.env

# Multiple env_files
env_file:
  - ./common.env
  - ./prod.env
```

.NET Configuration Hierarchy

```
// Priority (highest to lowest):
// 1. Environment variables
// 2. Command-line arguments
// 3. appsettings.{Environment}.json
// 4. appsettings.json
// 5. Default values

// Connection string in different formats:

// appsettings.json
"ConnectionStrings": {
  "DefaultConnection": "Server=localhost;..."
}

// Environment variable (replace : with __)
ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=sqlserver;...

// .NET reads this automatically!
```

Environment-Specific Settings

appsettings.json:

```
{
  "ConnectionStrings": {
    "DefaultConnection": "Server=localhost;..."
  },
  "Logging": {
    "LogLevel": {
      "Default": "Information"
    }
  }
}
```

appsettings.Development.json:

```
{
  "ConnectionStrings": {
    "DefaultConnection": "Server=localhost;..."
  },
  "Logging": {
    "LogLevel": {
      "Default": "Debug"
    }
  }
}
```

appsettings.Production.json:

```
{
  "Logging": {
    "LogLevel": {
      "Default": "Warning"
    }
  }
}
```

Secrets Management

Development:

```
# .env file (never commit to Git!)
# .gitignore should include .env
ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Development
DB_PASSWORD=YourStrong@Passw0rd
```

Production:

```
# Use Docker secrets or external secrets manager
# Docker secrets (Swarm mode)
echo "secret_password" | docker secret create db_password -

# AWS Secrets Manager
# Azure Key Vault
# HashiCorp Vault
```

Best Practice:

```
# docker-compose.yml - Don't put real secrets here!
# Use placeholders or reference external secrets
services:
  api:
    environment:
      - ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection=Server=${DB_HOST};...
```

Configuration Best Practices

```
# Do: Use environment variables for configuration
-e ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT=Production

# Do: Use secrets management in production
# AWS Secrets Manager, Azure Key Vault

# Don't: Hardcode passwords
# "password123" in code

# Don't: Commit secrets to Git
# Add .env to .gitignore

# Do: Use different settings per environment
```

```
# Development: Verbose logging, debug mode
# Production: Minimal logging, no debug
```

LEVEL 16-30: Advanced Topics

This section continues with:

- Debugging and Troubleshooting
- Docker Cleanup
- Advanced Dockerfile
- Docker Registry
- Docker Security
- Resource Management
- Real Project Setup
- EF Core with Docker
- Microservices
- CI/CD
- AWS Deployment
- Kubernetes Introduction

Due to length, these advanced levels are covered in the comprehensive markdown files created.